22 TIPS TO SUPERCHARGE YOUR AUDIO EXPERIENCE

That sounds good!

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When talking about the perfect audio experience, no one can make blanket statements, because the "one size fits all" philosophy does not fit in here. Audio experiences are some of the most subjective ones out there, so when making recommendations, one needs to be very careful. If you want to make your experience better than ever, catered to your taste, then here's a list of 22 tips that I curated to help you get a perfect audio listening experience –

01 Implement room correction

Room correction implies the hardware and software level adjustments made to ensure that you get the best audio experience possible regardless of the situation in your room with respect to your audio system. Room correction requires moderate levels of expertise with audio gear. To perform basic correction, you need to put in some money. You need to get your hands on a correction microphone like the miniDSP UMIK-1, an audio interface like the Focusrite Scarlett 2i2. Then, get software depending on your comfort level with audio tools. Here's a guide that I found online that'll help you get started with room correction – *https://dgit.in/DRCBasics*

02 Experiment with virtual surround sound

Virtual surround sound is advertised under different names depending on the brand of audio products you are looking at. Essentially what virtual surround sound does is that it modifies the audio output from your speaker/headphones to mimic additional speakers. While this technology wasn't as good at the time of launch, with time, it has gotten pretty effective, with brands like Sony making tremendous improvements in their implementation of virtual surround sound. If you want to try it for yourself and do not own the hardware that does not come baked in with this tech, then you can use third-party software to do it.

03 Mind the CODECs

CODECs are essentially indicative of the quality of the audio signal that is being transmitted between the source and the output device. Now, depending on the hardware and software capabilities of the devices communicating with each other, the CODEC being used can vary. But, at times when we are using Bluetooth to play audio, the devices default to the lowest quality CODEC. Thus, to ensure that you are making the most of your hardware, check the codec being used by the streaming software and the source device, and select the highest supported quality of the CODEC. There's a table to guide you through some high-quality CODECs that are used on the next page.

04 FLAC or ALAC?

FLAC and ALAC are one of the two most popular lossless audio compression formats out there. Apple Lossless Audio Codec (ALAC), as the name suggests, is Apple's lossless audio format, and is used by the people in the ecosystem as the alternative to FLAC, which is often termed as the industry standard in the lossless audio space. Free Lossless Audio Codec (FLAC), is open source and was developed in 2001. Audio files using these compression format are the ones that have the most amount of data stored in them, earning them the popular title of being lossless audio file format. Depending on the region, there are multiple ways in which you can get your hands on FLAC files. And, I am sure once you listen to your favourite tracks, you will notice some difference.

05 JACK (Jack Audio Connection Kit) it up!

If you are someone who is working with audio professionally, you'd know that there are multiple components to a DAW. So, what JACK does is that it lets multiple programs/components of your DAW to work together, ensuring streamlined workflow and efficiency, with added controls and centralisation of tasks. I know that there are multiple plugins that claim to do it all, but they pale in comparison to JACK. If you are even slightly